MENA ROBOTICS SUMMIT 2026

ACADEMIC POSTER COMPETITION

OFFICIAL RULES & REGULATIONS

Competition Date	**30 October 2026**
Submission Deadline	25 October 2026
Venue	Egypt-Japan University of Science and Technology (E-JUST)
Participation	Open eligibility; individual entries only
Format	In-person physical poster presentation
Poster Template	https://canva.link/6k4ltrtucl6t6re
Participation Fee	EGP 300, including event registration
Award	One overall winner — EGP 3,000
Official Contact	ahmed.elsheikh@ejust.edu.eg

1. Introduction

The Academic Poster Competition is part of MENA Robotics Summit 2026 at E-JUST. It provides a platform for students, researchers, engineers, professionals, and independent innovators to present research, engineering developments, prototypes, and innovative solutions in robotics and related technologies. Participants will present a physical academic poster and defend their work before an appointed judging committee.

2. Competition Scope

Submissions must demonstrate a clear connection to robotics or an enabling technology. Eligible areas include robotics and autonomous systems; artificial intelligence and machine learning; embedded systems and edge computing; automation and control; mechatronics and hardware design; assistive and human-centered technologies; and interdisciplinary engineering research with a demonstrable application to robotics, AI, embedded systems, or automation. The organizing committee determines whether a submission falls within scope.

3. Eligibility and Participation

3.1 Eligibility

The competition is open to individuals regardless of nationality, academic affiliation, educational level, or professional status, subject to event registration requirements. No specific university affiliation is required.

3.2 Individual Entries

- Each entry must be registered under one individual participant; group entries are not permitted.

- Participants may acknowledge supervisors, collaborators, laboratories, and other contributors.
- The participant must accurately describe their own contribution. Collaborative research is permitted when authorship and individual contributions are represented honestly.

3.3 Registration and Fee

Participants must complete the official registration process and submit all required information and materials through the channel announced by the organizing committee. The participation fee is EGP 300 and includes registration for MENA Robotics Summit 2026. Registration method, payment instructions, payment deadline, and refund/cancellation terms will be communicated through the official registration channel. The committee must publish payment instructions before collecting payment.

4. Submission Requirements

4.1 Deadline and Submission

All required materials must be received no later than 25 October 2026. The exact deadline time and time zone, submission channel, accepted file format, and maximum file size will be stated in the official submission instructions.

Each participant must submit a print-ready digital poster using the official template:

https://canva.link/6k4ltrtucl6t6re

4.2 Required Poster Content

- Research title, participant name, and affiliation where applicable.
- Background, motivation, problem statement, and objectives.
- Methodology, system architecture, algorithms, experimental design, or implementation approach.
- Results and validation, including appropriate evidence.
- Discussion, limitations, conclusions, and future work.
- References and acknowledgments, where applicable.

4.3 Originality and Accuracy

Posters must represent genuine research, engineering, or technical work. Participants must accurately report results, distinguish measured findings from simulations or proposed work, cite external material, and avoid fabricated data, falsified results, and misleading claims. Negative results and incomplete prototypes are not automatically grounds for rejection when honestly reported.

4.4 Revisions

Changes after the deadline require approval from the organizing committee. Late revisions may be refused where accepting them would compromise fairness or interfere with printing or judging.

5. Physical Poster and Printing

The organizing committee is responsible for printing the posters. Participants must submit a final, print-ready digital file in the required format by the announced deadline. Poster dimensions, orientation, accepted file format, file size limit, print-ready file deadline, correction procedure, and display arrangements will be communicated through the official template and event instructions.

Participants are responsible for checking the accuracy of their content before submission. The committee may request corrections or reject files that are corrupted, incomplete, or unsuitable for printing. Poster setup, check-in, and removal times will be communicated before the event.

6. Competition Format and Presentation

The competition will take place in person on 30 October 2026 at E-JUST. Each participant must check in, display their poster in the assigned location, remain available for evaluation, explain the problem, methodology, results, and contribution of the work, and answer questions professionally.

Presentation duration, question-and-answer duration, evaluation schedule, and check-in and setup times will be determined by the organizing committee and communicated before the event. The format may be adjusted according to the number of participants, available judges, venue constraints, and event schedule, while providing participants a reasonable opportunity to present and defend their work.

Late arrival or absence may result in a penalty or disqualification if it prevents a fair assessment. Exceptions may be considered at the committee's discretion; a replacement evaluation is not guaranteed.

7. Judging and Scoring

7.1 Judging Committee

Entries will be evaluated by a judging committee appointed by the organizing committee. Judges must assess entries objectively and disclose any actual or reasonably perceived conflict of interest. The committee will determine appropriate mitigation, including reassignment where necessary.

7.2 Official 100-Point Rubric

Criterion	Evaluation Focus	Maximum
Originality and Innovation	Novelty of the idea, approach, application, or engineering contribution	20
Technical Merit and Methodology	Soundness of methods, design, algorithms, and technical reasoning	20
Results and Validation	Evidence, experiments, benchmarks, testing, analysis, and validation	20
Relevance and Practical Impact	Connection to robotics and enabling technologies, feasibility, and potential impact	15
Poster Quality and Scientific Communication	Readability, organization, visual clarity, figures, and references	10
Oral Presentation and Defense	Clarity, technical understanding, interpretation, and responses to questions	15
TOTAL		100

7.3 Scoring Guidance

Judges should assess the originality of the contribution; the appropriateness and rigor of the methodology; the strength of evidence supporting conclusions; relevance and practical value; poster clarity; and the participant's ability to explain and defend the work. The expected evidence should be appropriate to the project's development stage.

7.4 Score Aggregation

Each judge will complete an official score sheet. The competition score will be the sum of the judges' total scores. The number of judges assigned to each poster must be confirmed before judging begins. For fair comparison, the same number of judges must score every poster. If that cannot be achieved, the committee must approve and publish a consistent normalization method before judging starts.

8. Winner and Tie-Breaking

One overall winner will be selected. The winner will be the eligible participant with the highest final aggregate score after verification. The award is EGP 3,000, together with a certificate. The award presentation time and location will be communicated by the organizing committee.

Ties will be resolved in this order: (1) higher Results and Validation score; (2) higher Technical Merit and Methodology score; (3) higher Originality and Innovation score; and (4) a documented comparative assessment by an impartial judge or panel using the published rubric. The same procedure must apply to all tied participants.

9. Research Integrity and Ethical Conduct

9.1 Plagiarism and Falsification

Plagiarism, substantial unattributed copying, fabrication of data, falsification of findings, deceptive manipulation of evidence, and misrepresentation of simulated or proposed results as completed experiments are prohibited. External text, figures, code, datasets, designs, and ideas must be appropriately acknowledged.

9.2 AI Disclosure

AI tools may be used for permitted activities, but participants remain responsible for the accuracy and integrity of their work. Participants must disclose material AI assistance in the poster or accompanying submission when it contributed substantively to the work. AI tools must not be used to fabricate evidence, invent references, or misrepresent the provenance of substantive work. The organizing committee may provide a standard disclosure statement in the submission instructions.

9.3 Intellectual Property

Participants retain ownership of their original work, subject to existing agreements, third-party rights, and applicable law. Submission does not automatically transfer intellectual property to E-JUST or the organizers. Participants must have permission to display third-party material. The committee may display posters during the competition and document the event for legitimate reporting purposes, subject to applicable law and required consent. Any broader license to reproduce, publish, distribute, or commercially use participants' work must be communicated separately where required.

9.4 Confidentiality and Safety

Participants must not disclose confidential, proprietary, personal, or restricted information without authorization. Projects involving human participants, personal data, animals, hazardous materials, or safety-critical systems must comply with applicable ethical, legal, and institutional requirements. Unsafe demonstrations are prohibited.

10. Prohibited Conduct and Disqualification

Violations may result in a warning, removal from judging, or disqualification depending on severity. Grounds include plagiarism; fabricated or falsified results; material misrepresentation of authorship or contribution; deliberately misleading registration information; improper attempts to influence judges; interference with another participant; repeated failure to follow reasonable venue or safety instructions; unauthorized disclosure of confidential information; or other serious violations of these rules or applicable law.

Where practicable, the participant will be informed of the concern and given an opportunity to respond before a final disqualification decision. Immediate removal may be necessary where safety, security, or competition integrity is at risk. Disqualified entries are ineligible for the award.

11. Appeals and Complaints

Appeals must be submitted within 30 minutes of the official announcement of results to ahmed.elsheikh@ejust.edu.eg. An appeal must identify the participant and poster, the decision challenged, specific grounds, and supporting evidence.

Valid grounds include a documented scoring or calculation error, a material procedural irregularity, an inadequately addressed conflict of interest, or an eligibility or disciplinary decision made contrary to the published rules. Disagreement with a judge's academic opinion alone is not sufficient.

An impartial reviewer or panel will review the appeal, inspect relevant records where necessary, and communicate the outcome. Possible outcomes include upholding the decision, correcting a verified error, repeating an affected procedural step, or reassessment where a material procedural failure is established. The appeal does not automatically suspend the competition or delay the award. The outcome is final within the internal competition process, subject to applicable law.

12. Organizer Authority

The organizing committee administers the competition, reviews eligibility, publishes submission instructions, coordinates printing and display, appoints judges, addresses conflicts of interest, verifies score calculations, investigates credible misconduct allegations, applies these rules, and announces the winner.

The committee may make reasonable operational adjustments for venue constraints, safety, scheduling, or circumstances beyond its reasonable control. Changes materially affecting eligibility, scoring, winner selection, or participant obligations must be communicated as early as reasonably possible and applied consistently. The rubric and tie-breaking procedure must not be changed retroactively to favor a participant. The committee may postpone, suspend, or cancel the competition when necessary and will notify participants through official channels whenever feasible.

13. Participant Acknowledgment

By registering and participating, each participant confirms that they have read and understood these rules, agree to comply with the submission and conduct requirements, confirm that submitted information is accurate to the best of their knowledge, accept responsibility for the accuracy and attribution of their work, understand the scoring and appeal procedures, and agree to follow reasonable instructions issued by the organizing committee.

14. Official Contact

MENA Robotics Summit 2026 — Academic Poster Competition

Egypt-Japan University of Science and Technology (E-JUST)

Email: ahmed.elsheikh@ejust.edu.eg

Poster template: https://canva.link/6k4ltrtucl6t6re

Issued by the MENA Robotics Summit 2026 Organizing Committee

Final operational details and submission instructions will be communicated through the official channels.